A short reflection on today's Gospel Matthew 25: 1-13

In today's Gospel, Jesus reminds us of the importance of being ready for His coming. While five of the bridesmaids are prepared with enough oil for their lamps, the other five are caught unprepared when the bridegroom arrives.

The message is simple but profound: we are called to keep our faith alive and our hearts ready for the Lord. This readiness is not about fear or worrying about the future, but about living each day with faith, love and trust in God.

The oil in our lamps can be seen as the everyday acts of kindness, prayer, forgiveness and generosity that nourish our relationship with Christ. These are the things that help our faith shine, especially when life becomes difficult or uncertain.

As members of our parish community, let us encourage one another to keep our lamps burning brightly. May we never become so distracted by the busyness of life that we forget to make room for God.

Lord, help us to remain watchful, faithful and ready to welcome You, keeping the light of Your love shining in our hearts and in the lives of those around us. Amen.

Prayer for Vocations to the Priesthood: During this month of November let us pray for the deceased priests who served our diocese and our parishes as we pray for the men who will take up their mantle in the years to come.

Remembrance of the Faithful Departed: The deceased members of our families and friends will be remembered at all Masses throughout November at St Eugene's Cathedral. Remembrance Cards are available at the back of the Cathedral. Please take a card, write the names of your loved ones, and place it in the basket on the Sanctuary.

Eternal rest grant unto them, O Lord, and let perpetual light shine upon them. May the souls of all the faithful departed, through the mercy of God, rest in peace. Amen.

Our Lady, Untier of Knots Novena - The Novena to Our Lady, Untier of Knots continues after the 7.30pm Mass on Thursdays, in St Eugene's Cathedral, concluding on Thursday 26th November. This Novena reminds us that sin never entangled Our Lady, and that Christ gave us His Mother as Our Lady, Untier of Knots. Through this devotion, we entrust our personal "knots" to her loving care - learning to let go and allowing her to gently untie what binds us. All are welcome to join in prayer and reflection during this special time of grace

Safeguarding Information Evening - Fr Paul Farren kindly invites all Parish staff, Sacristans, Readers, Eucharistic Ministers, Collectors, Children's Liturgy Facilitators, Pope John Paul II Award Leaders, SVDP members, Choir/ music Leaders, Cleaners, Ground Workers and all those interested in Safeguarding in our Parish, to a Safeguarding Information Evening in the Cathedral Hall on Thursday 19th November at 6.00 to 7.00 pm. Please RSVP to Parochial House on 02871262894 or email cathedral@derrydiocese.org by Tuesday 17th November. As safeguarding is a high priority in both our Parish and diocese, your attendance would be greatly appreciated.

Parish Advent Pilgrimage on Thursday 3rd December. Bus leaves Cathedral at 9.15am and returns at approx. 5.30pm. Morning Prayer in the IOSAS Centre followed by refreshments. Mass in St. Michael's Church, Urris, Clonmany and lunch in the Ballyliffin Hotel. Price £40 Includes Transport, Morning Tea & Lunch. For more information or to book a place call into the Parish Office or call 71262894 or email cathedral@derrydiocese.org This is a pre booking only event.

Sympathy

We offer our sympathy to the family and friends of:

Bernadette McGowan
John Corcoran
Paul McCallion
Tom McBrearty
Philip Walker

May they rest in peace

Anniversaries

Please pray for the repose of the souls of:

Margaret McConomy
Séan & Myra McCaul
Elizabeth (Lily) McCafferty
Gilllian Keaveney
Eddie McKinney
George Holmes
Michael Gallacher

May they rest in peace

Baptisms

We welcome as a member of God's family:

Darragh Charlie Thomas Balfour

To book a Baptism contact the Parish Office 02871 262894

Collection

Weekly Collection:	£5,791
Parish Development:	£1,067

Thank you for your generosity

Thank you

Fr Farren acknowledges with thanks the following donations for:

Mary's Meals: £20, £40
Gaza Appeal: £50
Water Aid: £100, £50
Sight Savers: £100, £40
Smile Train: £50, £40
Hungry Children: £100
Matt Talbot: £10
Viatores Christi: €200

Readers for 14th / 15th November

6.15pm	Claire O'Kane
7.30pm	Mary Morrison
9.30am	Kate Doherty
11.00am	St Joseph's BS
12.30pm	Michael Wilson
7.00pm	Anna Begley

Christmas Wreath Floral Workshop - Saturday 5th December at 12.00noon in the Cathedral Hall. Cost £20 which includes all flowers, sundries & refreshments. Pre booking required. Call into the Parish Office or phone, 028 71262894 or email cathedral@derrydiocese.org

Christmas Table Centre Workshop - Saturday 12th December at 12.00noon in the Cathedral Hall. Cost £20 which includes all flowers, sundries & refreshments. Pre booking required. Call into the Parish Office or phone, 028 71262894 or email cathedral@derrydiocese.org

Would you like to become an Altar Server in St Eugene's Cathedral? We are recruiting for anyone who is in Primary 5 and upwards, to come and serve at our weekend Masses. If you are interested in becoming an altar server, please email Lauren at lauren.doherty@derrydiocese.org or phone the parish office on 02871 262894 for more information.